

Requests Responses and JSON

Project: Verified Study Buddy

1. Requests, Responses, and JSON

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Parse JSON into Python records

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Tools and APIs

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Tools and APIs. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of tools and api contracts

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Tools expose structured operations with input and output contracts. Generating a tool call is a proposal; validation and authorisation decide whether it executes. For lookup_room accept exactly room_id as a nonempty string; return found plus capacity or a not-found result. It is read-only. Reject unknown arguments and do not replace missing values with invented facts.

User Need and AI Contribution

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from User Need and AI Contribution. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of capstone requirements and corpus

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A grounded-assistant capstone begins with bounded requirements and a versioned permitted corpus. A baseline can be a manual lookup process using the same evidence. Specify the user question, source authority, access, output/fallback contract and evaluation plan. Freeze corpus IDs and split cases before implementation. Keep teacher material out of student retrieval.

Verify Numbers and Dates

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Verify Numbers and Dates. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of claim support and citation evaluation

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Citation evaluation checks source existence, exact passage support and coverage of answer claims. A real citation can still be irrelevant. For this classroom rubric count a claim as supported only when its cited passage entails it. Separately count correct citation links. Use the number of factual claims as the support denominator.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

Request id=7 returns status=200 and {"id":8,"pages":90}. Explain why a successful status is insufficient and specify the handling.

Concept to explain

Term · Meaning

Term: request

Meaning: A message asking a system to return information or perform an action.

Term: response

Meaning: The information or status returned after a request.

Term: JSON object

Meaning: A collection of named fields and values written using JSON syntax, such as {"pages":80}.

Term: status

Meaning: A reported condition of a request or process, such as success, pending or error.

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Teach Week 26 as a two-session investigation using fictional data. A fictional activity service supplies JSON text. The input contract is a JSON object with name text and minutes an integer from 0 through 60. The output contract will be a record with accepted and minutes fields. Parsing valid JSON is only the first step. Assess the three stated outcomes through the independent task, not by copying the worked result.

Readiness answer

Reading obtains characters; validation checks whether their meaning and values satisfy rules.

Python 3 editor with a fresh local practice file

Paper trace table and the student workbook

Fictional input records from this lesson; no real student identifiers

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain requests responses and json using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain the mechanism

Explain the mechanism

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

1. Request requires question:text and source_ids:list.
2. Response requires answer:text, citations:list, status:text.
3. Missing citations or wrong source_ids type fails validation.
4. Error response should state code, message, and safe next step.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

Concrete teaching case

Request is for B7; response is {"id":"B7","pages":120}. Another response has malformed JSON.

What checks precede use?

Exact explanation to model

Request success, JSON validity, matching id, required fields and numeric type. Handle malformed responses explicitly.

Explain the added worked example

A fictional activity service supplies JSON text. The input contract is a JSON object with name text and minutes an integer from 0 through 60. The output contract will be a record with accepted and minutes fields. Parsing valid JSON is only the first step.

The output is {"accepted": true, "minutes": 12}. JSON uses lowercase true, false and null; Python uses True, False and None. json.loads converts between representations. The worked output line assumes the parsed top-level value is a dictionary; a robust interface must reject other top-level types before accessing fields.

Key terms

Term · Meaning

Term: JSON

Meaning: A text format for structured values

Term: Parsing

Meaning: Converting formatted text into program values

Term: Interface

Meaning: The agreed way one part of a system exchanges data with another

Term: Contract

Meaning: Specified inputs, outputs and error behavior

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

JSON text contains {"name": "Sketch", "minutes": "12"}. Does parsing fail, or does validation fail?

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Requests Responses and JSON

A lunch-count response must satisfy a declared JSON contract.

The facts we will use

The toy response has exactly `class_code` text and `portions` integer 0..30. Example:
`{"class_code": "R8", "portions": 12}`.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

Requests Responses and JSON

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Read fields

class_code is nonempty text; portions is the integer 12.



2. Check range

$0 \leq 12 \leq 30$, so the declared count is within range.



3. Accept structure

Accept this response shape; acceptance does not prove that 12 portions were actually counted.

CHANGE ONE THING

Replace 12 with the text "12".

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Read fields

What happens and why: class_code is nonempty text; portions is the integer 12.

Step: 2. Check range

What happens and why: $0 \leq 12 \leq 30$, so the declared count is within range.

Step: 3. Accept structure

What happens and why: Accept this response shape; acceptance does not prove that 12 portions were actually counted.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Read the picture in order. Accept this response shape; acceptance does not prove that 12 portions were actually counted. The arrows show which recorded input or intermediate result each decision uses. Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows.

What this example does not establish

JSON well-formedness, schema validity and real-world truth are different checks.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Replace 12 with the text "12".

Prediction: Reject the response under this strict contract.

Reason: Digits inside quotes represent text, whereas portions requires an integer.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: Request is for B7; response is `{"id":"B7","pages":120}`. Another response has malformed JSON.

Write the question to explain: What checks precede use?

Reveal after predictions: Request success, JSON validity, matching id, required fields and numeric type. Handle malformed responses explicitly.

Keep for an independent attempt: An API returns `{"ok":false,"error":"not_found"}`. Your app tries to display `response.title`. What should it do instead?

Classroom dialogue

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks evidence; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

Parsing succeeds; validation fails because minutes is text. Exit: No. Syntax, schema validity and observational truth are separate checks.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

Stage: Session 1 start to 7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the prerequisite and explain the purpose in the opening section.

Stage: 7 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Read the worked example and diagram; ask learners to trace each step aloud.

Stage: 20 to 33 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W1 and W2, then compare predictions with observed results.

Stage: 33 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Collect the guided prediction before running; discuss a mismatch and its cause.

Stage: Session 2 start to 8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the main rule without showing the previous answer.

Stage: 8 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Use W3 to diagnose and repair the stated failure; rerun an earlier case.

Stage: 20 to 35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently, including code or plan, predictions and explanations, before hints.

Stage: 35 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss W5 and the exit; use the fresh retry when support was needed.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Classify {"minutes": "5"} and {minutes: 5} as valid JSON text or malformed JSON.

Teacher check: The first is valid JSON but its minutes field fails the integer schema. The second is malformed because the key is not double-quoted.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for JSON and interface contracts. Proposed explanation: “A successful run proves the conclusion”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: An interface should state what happens for malformed text, wrong structure and invalid values. Do not expose raw private input in error messages. Use only the fictional records supplied for practice.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Would converting the text silently prove the source count is correct? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

No. Under the stated strict contract reject the wrong type. Any explicit conversion policy would change the contract, and factual verification remains separate. Changed-case check: Reject the response under this

strict contract. Digits inside quotes represent text, whereas portions requires an integer.

Changed-case reasoning: Reject the response under this strict contract. Digits inside quotes represent text, whereas portions requires an integer.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the weekly evidence lab

Run the weekly evidence lab

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.

Inspect eight objects for syntax, required fields, types, allowed values, and source ownership; repair without inventing data.

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing. Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record · What to capture

Record: Input or evidence

What to capture: Exact data, instruction or claim

Record: Expected result

What to capture: Answer or safe fallback declared before the run

Record: Observed result

What to capture: Actual result, including errors

Record: Explanation

What to capture: Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome

Record: Next test

What to capture: One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation. Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

A successful run proves the conclusion: An interface should state what happens for malformed text, wrong structure and invalid values. Do not expose raw private input in error messages. Use only the fictional records supplied for practice.

Matching the example is enough: Require the new W4 case, explicit predictions and an explanation. Fresh retry: label Tray and score integer 0 through 5. Cases score 0 accepted, score 6 rejected, score null rejected; JSON list rejected before field access.

A convenient shortcut preserves meaning: Single quotes around property names are not valid JSON syntax. Use double quotes in the JSON text. If the whole parsed value is a list, do not call `.get` on it: check the top-level type first and report a schema failure.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

Request success, JSON validity, matching id, required fields and numeric type. Handle malformed responses explicitly.

Independent question

An API returns `{"ok":false,"error":"not_found"}`. Your app tries to display `response.title`. What should it do instead?

Expected independent answer

Check the success or error fields before using result data. Show a useful not-found response and allow correction of the request.

What counts as evidence

Criterion · 0 points · 1 point · 2 points

Criterion: Result

0 points: Incorrect or absent

1 point: Partly correct

2 points: Correct with necessary conditions

Criterion: Reasoning

0 points: No supporting trace

1 point: Some steps

2 points: Clear mechanism, calculation or source support

Criterion: Limit

0 points: Overclaims certainty

1 point: Vague limitation

2 points: Relevant uncertainty or missing fact

Criterion: Transfer

0 points: Copies without adapting

1 point: Adapts with prompts

2 points: Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold. Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the evidence that challenges this claim: “Every API response contains successful result fields.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

The response is structurally plausible but for the wrong ID. Check status, parseability, required fields, types and matching ID before use. Reject or report the mismatch; do not silently attach another book’s page count to id=7.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Translate a value

What Python value does JSON null become? What JSON value represents Python True?

None and true, respectively.

Parsing JSON null produces Python None, while serialising Python True produces JSON true. The spelling belongs to the representation: lowercase true is JSON text, not the Python Boolean name True. Keep parsing and serialisation directions clear.

W2 Separate failures

Classify {"minutes": "5"} and {minutes: 5} as valid JSON text or malformed JSON.

The first is valid JSON but its minutes field fails the integer schema. The second is malformed because the key is not double-quoted.

W3 Repair the interface

A parser accepts a JSON list then crashes on .get. What check belongs before field access?

Require type(record) is dict and handle failure before any .get or keyed field access.

W4 Specify independently

Define a JSON contract for {"label": "Box", "count": 4}: nonempty text label, integer count 0 through 10. Give a valid case, a wrong-type case and a missing-field case with expected acceptance.

Valid Box/4 accepted; count "4" rejected for type; absent count rejected as missing. State that malformed JSON and non-object top levels are also rejected.

W5 Limit parsing

A JSON record parses successfully. Does that prove its observation is correct?

No. Syntax, schema validity and observational truth are separate checks.

No. Parsing checks JSON syntax. The schema separately checks the expected fields, types and ranges. Collection evidence is a third question: even a well-formed, schema-valid duration could have been measured or recorded incorrectly.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Define a JSON contract for {"label": "Box", "count": 4}: nonempty text label, integer count 0 through 10. Give a valid case, a wrong-type case and a missing-field case with expected acceptance.

Selected case answer

Valid Box/4 accepted; count "4" rejected for type; absent count rejected as missing. State that malformed JSON and non-object top levels are also rejected.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect and extend learning

Connect and extend learning

Verified Study Buddy

Use a stable request/response contract between interface, retriever, model, and verifier.

Keep the decision, input, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project evidence record.

Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Provide one short approved passage; separate instruction, input, output and evidence. Stretch: introduce an unsupported claim or conflicting source and validate claim by claim with a fallback.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more evidence or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 23: Block-to-Python Bridge. Retrieve today's evidence and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Color JSON punctuation separately from values. Extension: serialize a valid result, parse it again and check the data values are preserved.

Independent W4 evidence: Valid Box/4 accepted; count "4" rejected for type; absent count rejected as missing. State that malformed JSON and non-object top levels are also rejected. Record whether the learner needed no help, a hint or explanation. Fresh retry: label Tray and score integer 0 through 5. Cases score 0 accepted, score 6 rejected, score null rejected; JSON list rejected before field access.

Next week: Exceptions and recovery. Reuse this week's explicit contracts and evidence.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-3/23, ai-3/25, ai-3/28. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Verified Study Buddy, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.